

11.2.6 No pop-ups!

First off, unless you're designing a porn site, or one with plenty of advertisements, even the thought of a pop-up shouldn't cross your mind. Opening clicked links in new windows, or opening new windows automatically, must be avoided unless absolutely necessary. And these days, browsers pretty efficiently block pop-ups, so it becomes a pointless exercise anyway.



In true Times style, indiatimes has ads everywhere

11.2.7 No Archives, No Repeat Visitors

Especially for personal Web pages, it is a bad idea not to have your work archived for easy reference. Blog hosts usually provide this functionality within the blog template itself, but if you're designing your own from scratch, make sure people can access your old gems easily.

11.2.8 Horizontal scrolling

Since the inception of the Internet and Web sites, users have become accustomed to scrolling top-to-bottom on Web pages. Very rarely has one ever had to scroll left to right for anything unless it's a large image. And this is one trend that one must keep in mind while designing a Web site. Also, make sure your site is optimised for standard-sized windows (the standards keep changing, but 800 x 600 is generally considered OK).

11.2.9 Forget long URLs—people will!

There's no point having URLs that are more than 30 to 35 characters long! Too many dots, dashes, underscores and slashes don't do much more than confuse users, and the people they are giving the URL to. Keep your URLs short and related to the subject matter of the Web pages they link to.

11.2.10 The Four-Second Rule

If one cannot figure out what the site is about within four seconds